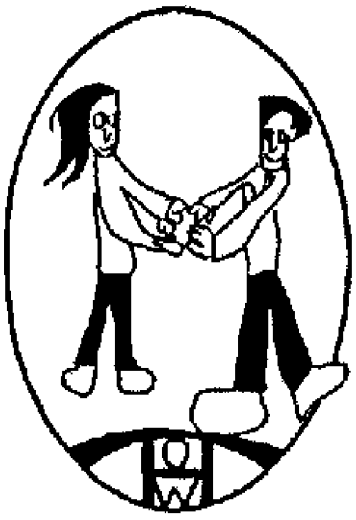
Howbridge Infant School



Special Educational Needs (SEN) Policy

Date last reviewed by Governing Body:
Summer 2026

SPECIAL EDUCATIONAL NEEDS POLICY

1. **Principle and Aim**

Our principle is that all children should be offered the same educational opportunities irrespective of gender, ethnic background, age or ability and to recognise that any child may have a special educational need during her/his time at school.

Our aim is:

- To include children with Special Educational Needs (SEN), to identify their needs as soon as possible and to give early support.
- Where there is a health problem to allow the child to manage it independently (if appropriate).
- To provide a stable and caring environment in which all children can learn and develop to their full potential within all aspects of school life.
- We acknowledge that all teachers are teachers of SEN and therefore responsible for meeting the needs of all individuals through High Quality Teaching.

2. **Legislation and guidance**

This policy and SEND Information Report (see website) is based on the statutory Special Educational Needs and Disability (SEND) Code of Practice and the following legislation:

- Part 3 of the Children and Families Act 2014, which sets out schools' responsibilities for pupils with SEN and disabilities
- The Special Educational Needs and Disability Regulations 2014, which set out schools' responsibilities for education, health and care (EHC) plans, SEN coordinators (SENCos) and the SEN information report.

3. **Definitions**

A pupil has Special Educational Needs (SEN) if they have a learning difficulty or disability which calls for special educational provision to be made for them.

They have a learning difficulty or disability if they have:

- A significantly greater difficulty in learning than the majority of others of the same age, or
- A disability which prevents or hinders them from making use of facilities of a kind generally provided for others of the same age in mainstreams schools

Special educational provision is educational or training provision that is additional to, or different from, that made generally for other children or young people of the same age by mainstream schools.

3. **Special Educational Needs Co-ordinator (SENCo)**

The SENCo has successfully completed the National Award for SEN Coordination.

The SENCo role is to

- manage learning support and provision for SEN children
- work with parents
- take the lead for managing the provision at SEN support and those with EHC plans
- maintain records including the SEN register
- liaise with other agencies
- report to governors annually
- line manage Teaching Assistants

4. **Named Governor**

- The named governors are Louise Cobb (Chair) and Toni Buck. As link governors their role is to liaise closely with the SENCo about provision and the needs of the children.

5. **Identification, Assessment and Provision**

It may be that some children cause concern to teachers and/or parents/carers, i.e. those whose overall attainments or attainment in specific subjects fall significantly outside the expected range. These children may require additional provision in addition to the High Quality Teaching in the classroom and be identified as having special educational needs. These children are discussed as soon as possible to ensure early

intervention and, if appropriate, are placed at SEN support level on the SEN register.

It is expected that:

- The guidelines in the Code of Practice (2014) and SEN & Disability Act 2001 are followed at all times.
- At the start of each academic year a review of the needs is made for each year group.
- According to needs and availability of staff, provision for specific needs are delivered through intervention groups: speech & language support; social and emotional nurture; social and behaviour skills.
- Children with specific medical and behavioural problems as well as those needing learning support may be placed on the school SEN support register depending on their level of need.
- Health Care Plans are put in place for children with medical needs. These are reviewed annually or when the condition/medication changes.
- Children with English as an Additional Language need careful assessment to establish whether the problems are due to their command of the language that is used or whether they would have SEN in their own language.
- The class teacher in consultation with the SENCo, parents and child writes an individual provision plan following a person centred meeting. The plan records that which is additional to, or different from, the differentiated curriculum. Views from all parties are recorded in the plan following the meeting.
- Every child on the SEN register has a One Page Profile which presents their views about themselves. These profiles along with the child's provision maps and any external assessments, e.g. paediatric reports, are collated to form a One Plan.
- Detailed One Plans are written for children with Education Health Care Plans or with very high needs. Views from the child, parents, school and outside agencies are included when structuring new targets.

6. **Admission Arrangements for pupils with SEN**

- Pupils with SEN either with or without an EHC plan are admitted according to the criteria set down in the school's Admission Policy.
- The SENCo collates and summarises all information received from other sources when children are entering the school and have previously been identified as SEN.

- If the information is not available the SENCo contacts appropriate sources and also gathers information from the parent/carer.
- Where possible the SENCo will attend Outcomes Meetings for children who are planning to join the school in the following September. These meetings form part of the EHCP application process.

7. **Special Provision**

The school has no specialisms above the normal SEN teaching available within mainstream school and no special unit.

8. **Facilities**

- The entrance to the school is accessible to wheelchairs.
- There are ramps leading into two different classrooms.
- A disabled toilet is situated in the library.
- There is ramped access from the playground to the playing field.
- Access to sensory equipment
- Community Room– quiet area for Speech and Language Therapy and small group work.

Further information can be found in our Accessibility Plan on the school website.

9. **Resources**

- The National SEN Fund supports the Funding for Teaching Assistants (TA) and provides for children needing additional SEN support; this is currently worked out as £6000 per pupil with SEN.
- At present there is a designated SEN resource budget or contingency fund of £600.
- For children with Complex or Severe needs additional top-up funding may be available. The amount of top-up funding per pupil is determined through EHCP Reviews. Personal Budget Allocations can also be granted under specific circumstances and can be found in Section J of the EHC Plans.
- Health Care Plans for children with medical needs are held in the School Office and in the SEN files in the classroom. Copies of these plans (with photographs of the children) are also in the school hall (MDA file) and with the SENCo – this is in order to raise the awareness of all adults in school of any potential emergency medical needs and appropriate actions to take. Children with food allergies also wear a lanyard with this information on to inform the kitchen and midday staff.
- SEN and EAL central resources are held in the Community Room.

- Gross Motor/large sensory equipment is held in the hall, and Rainbow Room.

10. **Access to the Curriculum**

Children with SEN are supported in the classroom. If they are withdrawn the SENCo and class teacher plan to ensure curriculum entitlement.

The needs of each year group are regularly reviewed.

11. Inclusion

- All staff aim to develop the full potential of all children. (Paragraph 1.)
- The Guidelines in the Special Educational Needs and Disability Act 2001 are followed at all times. The school follows the procedures in the SEN Code of Practice 2014.
- The transfer of children from special units is managed through liaison with all other agencies concerned to ensure continuity and security for the child and parents. (As stated in 6).

12. Transfer

When a child transfers into the school the class teacher ensures that s/he is integrated into the peer group at work and at play. Further information is sought from the previous school to support a smooth transition. Parents are met quickly to discuss any concerns regarding SEN.

13. Evaluating success

Our success criteria are

- To move children back through stages of SEN support (if appropriate) and eventually to discontinue additional SEN support taking into account that some children take longer than others to make progress.
- All children become more independent learners as they progress through school.
- The success criteria are monitored through the regular review of Provision Plans (the process of One Planning) and these plans are updated termly as further needs are identified.

The success of the SEN Policy and procedures is evaluated through the school self evaluation process.

14. Complaints Procedure

The complaints procedure is available on the school website.

15. Staff Training

- Staff development is through in house provision or specialist courses.
- Areas for training are identified on the School Improvement Plan/Inclusion Plan.
- SEND Inclusion Partners and educational psychologists may also deliver training to the staff.

16. Links with Other Agencies

The SENCo usually makes the initial contact. The school has good links with the School Nurse, Emotional Wellbeing Team, Attendance Compliance Team, Educational Psychologists (EP), NHS Speech and Language Therapists (SALT), Occupational Therapists (Physio, OT), and Pre-school providers. The SENCo meets with these agencies on a regular basis.

17. Partnership with Parents and Carers

- Good relationships with parents and carers are essential for the child's progress; parents and carers are kept informed at all times through formal (parents' evenings and SEN Person Centred Review meetings) and informal meetings.
- The SENCo is usually available to discuss pupils in person by appointment or by confidential telephone conversation if parents prefer.
- The Class Teacher and SENCo also give support to parents and carers to help children at home. Additional family support can be accessed using the Essex Children and Families Hub or the Essex Child and Family Wellbeing Service.
- When parents request advice or details about specific areas of need, staff try to provide appropriate training, information or contact.

18. Links with other schools

- Annual reviews for all Year 1 children with an EHCP takes place in the summer term. At this point parents request their child's Year 3 school choice. 'Light touch' Year 2 annual reviews then follow in October to

confirm any updates or changes to Year 3 placement requests. The SENCo will inform the junior school if their school is being requested.

- In the early spring term the SENCo from the junior school is informed about the children with SEN, prior to discussion and transfer of records. This happens earlier for children with EHCPs or high level medical needs.
- The SENCo makes contact with previous schools for new entrants who start throughout the year who have additional needs.
- There are good links with feeder nursery and pre-school settings prior to the September intake into EYFS. Staff may visit children in their feeder setting prior to admission to liaise with staff regarding particular needs.

19. Links with other agencies and health

- Social Services are consulted, if needed, and the SENCo liaises with social workers supporting our families on a regular basis.
- There is regular contact with other agencies, e.g. Provide.
- Links with voluntary agencies are made as appropriate to specific cases.

20. Review

- This policy is reviewed annually as part of the subject development programme.
- It is re-drafted periodically to take account of the school's development plan, new local and national curriculum requirements.

Reviewed by: Hannah Appleton Next review: May 2027

Addendum

Personnel:

SENCo	Hannah Appleton
SEN Governors	Louise Cobb and Toni Buck
Educational Psychologist	Helen O'Neill
SEND Operations Staff	Denise Jones (Partner) Lola Addai (Co-ordinator) Sophia Mair (Assistant)
NHS Occupational Therapist	Florencia Loray
NHS Physiotherapist	None at present
NHS Speech and Language Therapist	Kirsten Barton
SEND Inclusion Partner	Sarah Clemence
Specialist Teacher Team	Teacher of the Deaf Rosie Lennon Multi sensory specialist teacher Karen Corona PNI Specialist Teacher Jo Lambert VI Specialist Teacher Jan Watson